

From: [Paulu, Chris](#)
To: [Smith, Andy E. \(DHHS\)](#)
Subject: CP - work update, weeks ending 05/01/2009
Date: Friday, May 1, 2009 5:05:11 PM

On my Plate

- EPHT – Cognos AVR development
- Portal development
 - Glossary/text
 - Security issues
 - Water CWG
 - Enterprise Address Geocoding Tool
 - Asthma/air surveillance
 - Arsenic in wells mapping project
 - Birth outcomes multi-state project
- Lead - update, re-sync of geocoded/cleaned address data
- Cancer – North Deering inquiry
- geocoding protocol
- Program – Arsenic exposure study
- ME-CDC – Data Access Workgroup
- Epi Resource group
- USM – Meetings, misc.

These week's activities

EPHT

Portal development - Data display creation:

- Re-jiggered informational “About” pages for Asthma, both now hosted by Cognos
 - features pop-up links to Contact and Glossary pages
 - About the Data page has internal link (aka bookmark) to skip from top to Technical Info section
 - Problem: “static” content served by Maine.gov has automatic maine.gov header – which has Portal-unrelated items and will only confuse our users. We need to find a way to disable this or else use another host.
- Asthma page feedback
 - Good comments/observations from Eric, raising some tricky

issues

- No comments from any other beta tester
- Spec'ing CO tabbed page
 - Meeting with KD and LP
 - Pretty straightforward, data scope is manageable
 - One curiosity is mixing in BRFSS CO-detector data: nice to include for comparison, but it's different in terms of units (=household) and source (survey).
- Lisa noted an odd output with the Asthma Chart tool:
 - If a user selects a checkbox for gender but does not click 'Next', and then picks another prompt option...it's possible to get a display with a misnomer title.
 - I'm not sure if this will matter. It depends on how methodical the users are. There are workarounds...

Portal development –Cognos security. Found another backdoor into Cognos, quite by accident. It's not clear if it allows the anonymous user to enact any damage, but it does look like a way to see things that are supposed to be hidden. It also would allow a logged in user to see things they shouldn't see, and perhaps execute actions upon likewise.

Portal sideshow, Cognos reliability: Last weekend's outage is blamed on a faulty web cache, not related to Cognos. The OIT guy, Jason Tourtelotte, says it would usually be cleared by reloading the page. I'm pretty sure that didn't work last Sunday though!

Roles

Not yet.

Water Content – need to get back to Cognos pages of Water NCDMs someday...

Air Content– have data; one Cognos report to date.

Address Geocoding Tool – Mike F. sent a "Production" URL. To me, it looks like it still suffers from verbiage and cosmetic issues that I raised in several meetings. The last prior email from Mike seemed to check off a list of to-do's though. I'll have to revisit that. I updated the Geocoding URL per Rene's instructions. Someday it will show up in the Prod Portal.

Asthma/Air Surveillance – no developments.

Birth Outcomes multi-state analysis – no developments.

Arsenic in wells mapping project – no devs.

Other EPHT – GIS Day at Albany is next Tuesday, with training day on Wednesday (Google Earth and SAS spatial aggregation tool). I'm still working on logistics of attending either or both days.

Lead

Support – met with KD and SX to discuss updating Lead surveillance data, geocoding, etc. Also created spreadsheet of town-level summary numbers for Joe, 2003-2007.

Cancer

North Deering inquiry – report from Kathy, some queries from Molly. Still haven't looked at it yet.

Geocoding protocol – no developments.

CO surveillance

Issues with ecologic analysis – Follow-up meeting with Doug, not scheduled yet. Asked for Doug's presentation form EPHT Conference, never received.

Program

Arsenic Exposure Study – no developments.

MHDO data issues – Wondering about asthma data for 2003.

ME-CDC

Data Workgroup – no devs from my vantage.

Epi Resource workgroup – created draft wiki page for Epi group.

USM

Meetings, goings-on – nothing new.

Deadlines

Demo Portal – 'complete' demo of new Asthma Portlet [Done, basically]

Portal, portal, portal

- move on to CO, other topics;
- follow-up on Cognos security issues

Time spent:

- 85% - EPHT Portal-related
- 10% - Lead support/data request
- <5% - Water CWG: data generation, conference calls
- <5% - Geocoding Tool development
- <5% - ME-CDC meetings
- <5% - this update
- <5% - USM meetings